

News Release

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8:30 A.M. (Eastern) Thursday, September 24, 2026

UNEMPLOYMENT INSURANCE WEEKLY CLAIMS

SEASONALLY ADJUSTED DATA

In the week ending September 19, the advance figure for seasonally adjusted **initial claims** was 197,000, a decrease of 1,000 from the previous week's revised level. The previous week's level was revised up by 2,000 from 196,000 to 198,000. The 4-week moving average was 202,250, a decrease of 1,750 from the previous week's revised average. The previous week's average was revised up by 750 from 203,250 to 204,000.

The advance seasonally adjusted **insured unemployment rate** was 1.1 percent for the week ending September 12, unchanged from the previous week's unrevised rate. The advance number for seasonally adjusted **insured unemployment** during the week ending September 12 was 1,719,000, an increase of 2,000 from the previous week's revised level. The previous week's level was revised down by 13,000 from 1,730,000 to 1,717,000. The 4-week moving average was 1,744,000, a decrease of 13,000 from the previous week's revised average. The previous week's average was revised down by 4,250 from 1,761,250 to 1,757,000.

UNADJUSTED DATA

The advance number of actual initial claims under state programs, unadjusted, totaled 163,811 in the week ending September 19, an increase of 10,243 (or 6.7 percent) from the previous week. The seasonal factors had expected an increase of 10,475 (or 6.8 percent) from the previous week. There were 180,992 initial claims in the comparable week in 2025.

The advance unadjusted insured unemployment rate was 1.0 percent during the week ending September 12, unchanged from the prior week. The advance unadjusted level of insured unemployment in state programs totaled 1,552,283, a decrease of 13,371 (or -0.9 percent) from the preceding week. The seasonal factors had expected a decrease of 15,451 (or -1.0 percent) from the previous week. A year earlier the rate was 1.1 percent and the volume was 1,718,818.

The total number of continued weeks claimed for benefits in all programs for the week ending September 5 was 1,588,612, a decrease of 102,149 from the previous week. There were 1,790,468 weekly claims filed for benefits in all programs in the comparable week in 2025.

No state was triggered "on" the Extended Benefits program during the week ending September 5.

Initial claims for UI benefits filed by former Federal civilian employees totaled 362 in the week ending September 12, a decrease of 38 from the prior week. There were 358 initial claims filed by newly discharged veterans, a decrease of 140 from the preceding week.

There were 5,105 continued weeks claimed filed by former Federal civilian employees the week ending September 5, a decrease of 339 from the previous week. Newly discharged veterans claiming benefits totaled 4,975, an increase of 260 from the prior week.

UNEMPLOYMENT INSURANCE DATA FOR REGULAR STATE PROGRAMS

WEEK ENDING	September 19	September 12	Change	September 5	Prior Year¹
Initial Claims (SA)	197,000	198,000	-1,000	207,000	219,000
Initial Claims (NSA)	163,811	153,568	+10,243	177,695	180,992
4-Wk Moving Average (SA)	202,250	204,000	-1,750	206,250	236,750

WEEK ENDING	September 12	September 5	Change	August 29	Prior Year¹
Insured Unemployment (SA)	1,719,000	1,717,000	+2,000	1,765,000	1,916,000
Insured Unemployment (NSA)	1,552,283	1,565,654	-13,371	1,668,037	1,718,818
4-Wk Moving Average (SA)	1,744,000	1,757,000	-13,000	1,776,750	1,926,250
Insured Unemployment Rate (SA) ²	1.1%	1.1%	0.0	1.1%	1.3%
Insured Unemployment Rate (NSA) ²	1.0%	1.0%	0.0	1.1%	1.1%

INITIAL CLAIMS FILED IN FEDERAL PROGRAMS (UNADJUSTED)

WEEK ENDING	September 12	September 5	Change	Prior Year¹
Federal Employees (UCFE)	362	400	-38	635
Newly Discharged Veterans (UCX)	358	498	-140	420

CONTINUED WEEKS CLAIMED FILED FOR UI BENEFITS IN ALL PROGRAMS (UNADJUSTED)

WEEK ENDING	September 5	August 29	Change	Prior Year¹
Regular State	1,561,544	1,664,173	-102,629	1,753,149
Federal Employees	5,105	5,444	-339	8,168
Newly Discharged Veterans	4,975	4,715	+260	4,495
Extended Benefits ³	18	15	+3	14
State Additional Benefits ⁴	3,073	3,018	+55	2,596
STC / Workshare ⁵	13,897	13,396	+501	22,046
TOTAL	1,588,612	1,690,761	-102,149	1,790,468

FOOTNOTES

SA - Seasonally Adjusted Data, NSA - Not Seasonally Adjusted Data Continued weeks claimed represent all weeks of benefits claimed during the week being reported, and do not represent weeks claimed by unique individuals.

1. Prior year is comparable to most recent data.
2. Most recent week used covered employment of 153,732,307 as denominator.
3. Information on the EB program can be found here: [EB Program information](#)
4. Some states maintain additional benefit programs for those claimants who exhaust regular benefits, and when applicable, extended benefits. Information on states that participate, and the extent of benefits paid, can be found starting on page 4-5 of this link: [Extensions and Special Programs PDF](#)
5. Information on STC/Worksharing can be found starting on page 4-11 of the following link: [Extensions and Special Programs PDF](#)